



IKS – INDIAN KNOWLEDGE SYSTEMS

UNIT 2 - YOGA BASIC PRACTICES AND PHILOSOPHY

LECTURE BY: DR. ALKA M. BHIVANDKAR

18th August, 2025

SCOPE OF STUDY

UNIT 2.1

1. Maharshi Patanjali
2. Swami Satyananada Sarawati
- 3. B.K.S. Iyengar**
4. Swami Kuvalayananda
5. Shri Yogendra

UNIT 2.2

1. Body loosening exercises
2. Importance of breath
3. Developing concentration
4. Yoga for mind – body wellness

SHANTI PRAYER

Krishna Yajurveda Taittiriya Upanishad (2.2.2)

ॐ सहनाववतु
सह नौ भुनक्तु
सह वीर्यं करवाव है
तेजस्वि नावधीतमस्तु मा विद्विषाव है
ॐ शान्तिः शान्तिः शान्तिः

Om Saha nāvavatu
Saha nau bhunaktu
Saha vīryam karavāvahai
Tejasvi nāvadhītamastu
Mā vidviṣāvahai
Om Shāntiḥ, Shāntiḥ, Shāntiḥ

Om, May we all (Teacher and student) be protected
May we all be nourished
May we work together with great energy
May our intellect be sharpened (may our study be effective) ; Let there be no Animosity amongst us
Om, peace, peace, peace



B.K.S. IYENGAR

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BELLUR KRISHNAMACHAR SUNDERARAJA (B.K.S.) IYENGAR



B.K.S. IYENGAR



- Born: 14 December 1918 in Bellur, Karnataka, India
- Died: 20 August 2014 in Pune, Maharashtra at the age of 95 years
- Known as YOGACHARYA B.K.S Iyengar
- Famous for Iyengar Yoga
- Alignment based practice

EARLY LIFE

- B.K.S. Iyengar was born on 14th December 1918 into a poor Iyengar family, a priestly Brahmin caste in the tiny village of Bellur, in Karnataka, South India
- He was the eleventh of thirteen children and was born to a mother during the influenza pandemic
- His father, Shri krishnamachar, was a school teacher
- His mother was Sheshamma
- Throughout his childhood he was a weak and sickly child as he suffered from severe illnesses
- His schooling was limited due to a series of illnesses including typhoid, malaria, tuberculosis and malnutrition

EARLY LIFE

- His continued ill-health, malnutrition and poverty left him at fourteen with a low life expectancy.
- His body was so stiff that when he bent over to touch his toes, his middle fingers only reached his knees.
- These odds were against Iyengar reaching adulthood
- In 1934, at the age of 15 years he was sent to Mysore and kept under the custody of his brother –in-law, to learn Yoga, so as to improve his health
- Shri Tirumalai Krishnamacharya, the legendary yoga guru started teaching YOGA to young B.K.S. Iyengar
- This was a turning point in his life....!

INITIATION INTO YOGA

- Young Iyengar had little choice but to take up yoga for the sake of his immediate physical health
- He took up rigorous yoga practice under the tutelage of his brother-in-law and guru the venerable yogi Sri Tirumalai Krishnamacarya in Mysore.
- His apprenticeship under the Guru was rigorous, harsh, uncompromising and fierce
- At the age of 18 in 1937 he was sent to Pune, far away from his family, to teach Yoga
- But by this time he was determined to devote himself to yoga in spite of poverty and low recognition
- Practising up to ten hours a day he earned only a meagre living from his teaching and often went hungry

SPREADING YOGA

- Through self-practice, experimentation and teaching, he developed a unique, precise approach to yoga postures
- One famous pupil of Iyengar was the world renowned violinist Yehudi Menuhin, who came to study with Iyengar in 1952 because he had reached a crisis in his playing
- In recognition of the profound benefits Menuhin derived from the practice of yoga, Menuhin invited him to teach yoga in the West. He would later describe Iyengar as “my greatest violin teacher.”
- In the 1960s an enlightened educator asked Iyengar to teach yoga for the then London Education Authority.
- This was a highly influential programme which established Iyengar yoga in the UK

FOUNDATION OF IYENGAR YOGA

- Iyengar practiced fluid and extraordinarily fast movements between poses. But gradually he realised that such a practice was only possible for younger fit people and tended towards inaccuracy
- Iyengar began to slow down his practice to explore every aspect of each asana. This was the beginning of a comprehensive investigation which would lead to a worldwide transformation of the subject.
- Iyengar always encouraged personal resourcefulness in using what was at hand in the teaching of yoga

IYENGAR YOGA

- Iyengar realised that some people were unable to do the classical asanas
- Iyengar used whatever was around to assist them; in the beginning it was a household objects such as a pot, a brick, a piece of rope. In earlier years he was ridiculed for this in India and called a 'furniture yogi'.
- Focus of Iyengar Yoga is on body alignment, precision, sequencing and use of props (blocks, straps, bolsters) to make yoga accessible to all. It emphasises standing poses, backbends, and inversions as central to yogic practice

IYENGAR YOGA

- Iyengar Yoga is also a designed yoga therapy methods for those with injuries, chronic illness, disabilities, and stress-related problems



Adhomukha Virasana



Paschimottasana



Salamba Sarvangasana



Adhomukha Paschimottasana



Janu Sirsasana



Adhomukha Swastikasana



Halasana



Setubandha Sarvangasana



Viparita Karani



SPREADING YOGA

- By 1975 Iyengar designed and built his own place of teaching, the Ramamani Iyengar Memorial Yoga Institute (RIMYI) in Pune, named after his wife Ramamani
- At the RIMYI Institute and beyond, Iyengar worked alongside Western doctors to search for ways to combat illness by actively involving the patient in the treatment of their illness or medical condition. “My compassion is merciless,” Iyengar explained, “I fight with the affliction not with the person.”
- Much of Iyengar’s remedial and therapeutic work has been published and many trials and scientific studies have shown extraordinary results

RAMAMANI IYENGAR MEMORIAL INSTITUTE , PUNE



LEGACY OF BKS IYENGAR

- B.K.S. Iyengar was not just a yoga teacher — he was a global reformer, a precision artist of the human body, a spiritual guide.
- His life is a testimony to how suffering can become strength and how dedication can change the world, one posture at a time
- BKS Iyengar founded Iyengar Yoga, and is an author of classic yoga texts, global promoter of yoga therapy and alignment-based practice
- He emphasized discipline (abhyasa), patience, and self-awareness and integrated asana, pranayama and philosophy to elevate yoga beyond just physical fitness

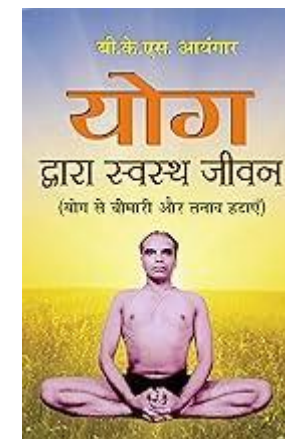
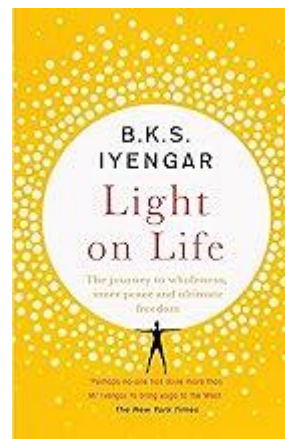
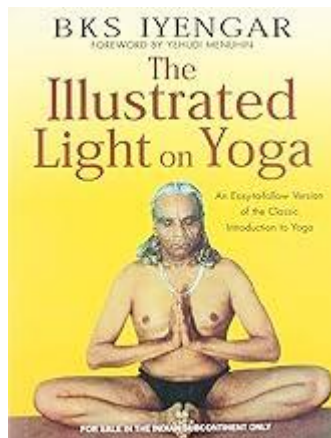
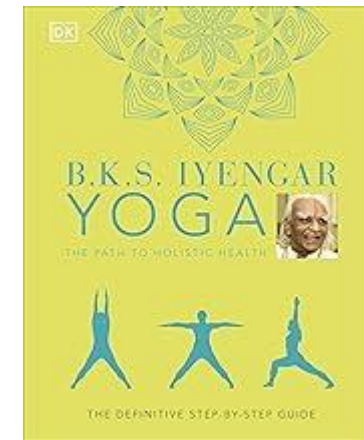
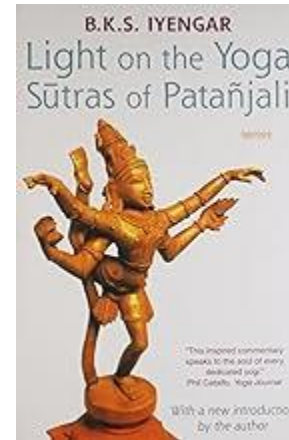
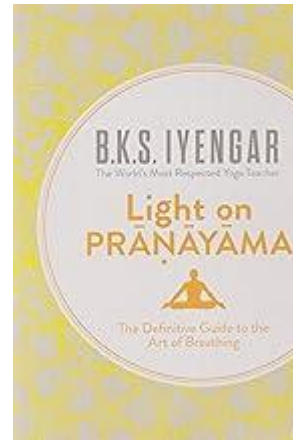
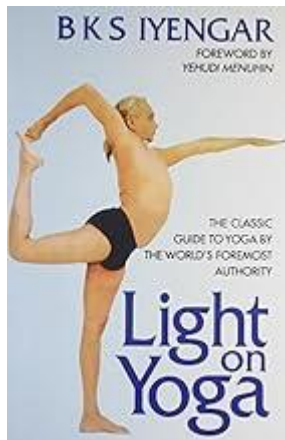
LEGACY OF BKS IYENGAR

- RIMYI has become a global hub for serious yoga students and teachers.
- Now there are several thousand teachers of Iyengar yoga working individually and in over 1800 institutes in 40 countries
- Until his death on 20th August 2014 Iyengar lived and taught at RIMYI with two of his children Geeta and Prashant.
- His granddaughter Abhijata has also taught at RIMYI which is the heart of what has become known as Iyengar yoga.

HONOURING BKS IYENGAR

- B.K.S. Iyengar received various recognition and Awards amongst them :
 - Padma Shri (1991)
 - Padma Bhushan (2002)
 - Padma Vibhushan (2014)
 - India's second-highest civilian award
- He was featured on Time magazine's 100 most influential people list in 2004

BOOKS BY B.K.S. IYENGAR





THANK YOU